

Group A/B

Participant Information Sheet

Creativity: schizophrenia's 'missing link'? (IRAS ID: 225295)

My name is Oliver Delgaram-Nejad, and I'm conducting this research as part of my PhD at MMU (Manchester Metropolitan University).

What is the study about?

This study is about creative language and schizophrenia. I want to see if there is a relationship between creativity and the speech changes that can sometimes occur with schizophrenia. The findings from this study could advance our understanding of these speech changes and may prompt clinicians to think about language differently.

What do you mean by creative language?

By creative language, we mean the language of creative writers. Poets and novelists often break the 'rules' of language to achieve their effects: to inspire unique feelings, ideas, and perspectives.

Why have I been approached?

You have been approached because we are looking for adults who have a diagnosis of schizophrenia and whose experiences may have included some of the language changes that we are exploring.

Do I have to take part?

No. It's completely up to you to decide whether you take part; you can withdraw at any point, without giving reason; your decision to participate/not participate/withdraw will never affect the quality of your care. If you decide to take part, we would ask you to sign a consent form: to verify that you have understood this information and wish to take part.

What will I be asked to do if I take part?

If you decide to take part, we would ask you to complete a task that explores creative language and then answer some questions about it. The task does not test your ability; there are no right or wrong answers. It takes approximately twenty minutes to complete. You would be asked to view phrases and add words to them. Then, you would be asked to participate in a semi-structured interview. These interviews are informal discussions that address set topics: this one is expected to last fifteen minutes. To produce a transcript of your responses, I will need an audio record of the interview. If you wish, you can specify a pseudonym, which will be used in the final report. If you do not provide a pseudonym, I will assign one randomly. Your data will be anonymous to everyone outside of the research team. Breaks will be offered at regular intervals, and you are welcome to request breaks at any time. It is standard practise that we notify your GP of your involvement, but we will need your consent to do this; you can take part without your GP being notified. We can reimburse travel expenses incurred in association with participation.

Will my data be identifiable?

The information you provide is confidential. The data collected for this study will be stored securely, and only the researchers conducting this study will have access to this data:

- At the end of the study, electronic copies of all data will be kept securely (on an encrypted computer) for ten years. At the end of this period, they will be destroyed.
- We will ask you to sign a consent form, which will be scanned and stored electronically on an encrypted hard drive (that is, no-one other than the researchers will be able to access it), and the computer itself will be password protected. Consent forms will be retained for no more than ten years.
- Your personal data will remain confidential and will be kept separately from your responses.

There are some limits to confidentiality: if your responses make me think that you, or others, are at significant risk of harm, I will have to break confidentiality and speak to a member of staff. But, whenever possible, I will tell you if I must do this.

What will happen to the results?

The results will be summarised and reported in my thesis; they may also be submitted for publication in (academic or professional) journals and/or presented at conferences.

Are there any risks?

Taking part in this project carries no physical risk. However, it is possible that you might experience some fatigue or distress from taking part. Though unlikely, if this occurs you are encouraged to inform the researcher and contact the resources listed at the end of this sheet.

Are there any benefits to taking part?

We cannot guarantee that this study will benefit you personally, but the information we receive will help to improve the understanding and treatment of schizophrenia.

Who has reviewed the project?

This study has been reviewed and approved by both the NHS REC (Research Ethics Committee) and a member of the research ethics and governance team at MMU.

What are my rights under data protection law?

This study is sponsored by MMU, which is based in the United Kingdom. MMU will also act as the study's data controller, which means that it is responsible for the safekeeping and proper use of your data. In order to undertake this study, we will use information provided with consent; to safeguard your rights, the minimum amount of person-identifiable information would be collected. MMU would use your name to establish consent, and participating NHS Trusts would use your name and contact details to discuss participation. Individuals from MMU, DPT, and regulatory organisations may ask to review informed consent forms to check the quality of the study. Your informed consent form would be kept for ten years after the study has finished. If you withdraw, your informed consent form will be destroyed securely at the point of withdrawal.

If you have any questions about your information, please contact the sponsor's representative:

Alison Lloyd
Research ethics and governance manager
Tel: +44 (0)161 247 2836 | e-Mail: a.lloyd@mmu.ac.uk
Manchester Metropolitan University | Manchester | M15 6BH

How are you responding to COVID-19?

You can choose to participate remotely or in person. For remote study visits, you will need access to a computer and video conferencing software. We will show you how to access the resources needed to participate. For in-person study visits, we will supply you with personal protective equipment (PPE): face masks and gloves. If you cannot make your own way to the study venue, do not use public transport. We will arrange for a taxi instead. If you are shielding, you can still take part. But we advise against in-person visits. As above, you can withdraw at any time, without giving reason. If you choose in-person visits and withdraw, you can keep any PPE supplied to you. If you wish to participate in person but would rather not do so now, you can wait until legislation and guidance changes before participating.

Where can I obtain further information about the study if I need it?

If you have any questions about the study or if any aspect of this study concerns you, please contact the main researcher:

Oliver Delgaram-Nejad
Postgraduate research student
Tel: +44 (0)7932009931 | e-Mail: 16060701@stu.mmu.ac.uk
Department of Languages, Information, and Communications | Department of Psychology | Manchester
Metropolitan University | Manchester | M15 6BH

Complaints

If you wish to make a complaint or raise concerns about any aspect of this study, and do not want to speak to the researcher, you should contact the project's supervisor:

Professor Dawn Archer
Director of Studies
Tel: +44 (0)161 247 3887 | e-Mail: d.archer@mmu.ac.uk
Faculty of Arts and Humanities | Manchester Metropolitan University | Manchester | M15 6BH

Alternatively, if you would like to speak to someone at the university who is not part of the research team, you should contact:

Professor Khatidja Chantler
Faculty Head of Ethics
Tel: +44 (0)161 247 1316 | e-Mail: k.chantler@mmu.ac.uk
Faculty of Health, Psychology & Social Care
Manchester Metropolitan University | Manchester | M15 6GX

Resources in the event of distress

Should you feel distressed, either by taking part or in the future, the following resources may be of assistance:

Mental Health Foundation

Tel: +44 (0)300 123 3393 (Monday-Friday, 9am-6pm)

Web: www.mentalhealth.org.uk

Mind

Tel: +44 (0)300 123 3393 (Monday-Friday, 9am-6pm)

Web: www.mind.org.uk

Rethink Mental Illness

Tel: +44 (0)300 5000 927 (Monday-Friday, 9.30am-4pm)

Web: www.rethink.org